



The Congo Rain Forest

The second-largest tropical rain forest on Earth, home to more than 11,000 plant species

One of the world's most important remaining wilderness areas, the Congo Rain Forest covers around 70,000 square miles (72 million square km) of central Africa's Congo River Basin, stretching across six countries.

Last refuge

Second in size to the Amazon, this warm, wet region is hugely biodiverse, with more than 600 tree species and 10,000 animal species. Vegetation is so thick in parts of the forest that it has become a last refuge for some of the most endangered species on Earth. Rare forest elephants, okapis, bonobos, and both eastern and western gorillas live in the Congo, as do hundreds of plant species found nowhere else.

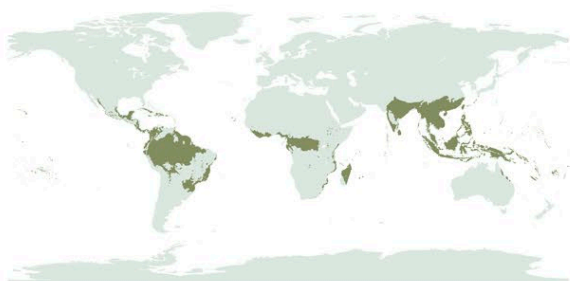
▷ RED FLAGS

The tropical dogwood, or red flag bush, is often found beside streams in the rain forest.



THE WORLD'S TROPICAL RAIN FORESTS

Tropical rain forests occur around Earth's equatorial regions, between the latitude lines of the Tropic of Cancer (23° North) and the Tropic of Capricorn (23° South). The largest coincide with South America's Amazon and Africa's Congo river basins, while Southeast Asia and India also have significant rain forest coverage. Northeast Australia has a small area of rain forest on its eastern side, stretching from coastal hills down to the sea.



△ VERSATILE MIMIC

The African grey parrot feeds on nuts, seeds, and fruit. It mimics other bird and mammal calls, as well as human speech.

